

Empowered Leadership in Action: Dr. Ankita Singh's Vision for a Resilient and Sustainable Future

Every organization needs a compass — a leader who can navigate uncertainty while inspiring others to rise to the occasion. In an era where adaptability and innovation drive corporate success, the role of leadership in overcoming challenges has never been more critical. Dr. Ankita Singh, Chief People Officer and Board of Director at CIGNEX and Relevance Lab, as well as Chief People Officer at Excellerent Solutions, embodies the essence of modern leadership. With over two decades of transformative experience, she has become a source of inspiration for organizations striving for resilience and sustainability amid disruption. Her journey reflects a commitment not only to empowering people but also to building systems that thrive in the face of adversity.



■ Dr. Ankita Singh

Chief People Officer and Board of Director
at CIGNEX and Relevance Lab

The Catalyst for Change in HR Practices

Dr. Ankita Singh's foray into Human Resources was not merely a career choice but a mission. Transitioning from an engineering background to HR, she brought a unique perspective to the discipline, one that balances analytical rigor with emotional intelligence. This synthesis of technical expertise and empathy has allowed her to pioneer practices that are as innovative as they are inclusive. At the heart of her philosophy is a simple yet powerful belief: "Empowered people create empowered organizations."

In her dual roles as Founder of the HR Association of India and as a leader across multiple companies, Dr. Ankita Singh exemplifies transformative leadership.

Her unwavering dedication and commitment to excellence shape organizational cultures and talent management practices. As a champion of diversity, inclusion, and collaboration, Dr. Singh's legacy continues to inspire generations, leaving an indelible mark on the business landscape and society as a whole.

Leading Through Crisis: A Masterclass in Agility

The COVID-19 pandemic tested the mettle of leaders worldwide, and Dr. Singh's response was nothing short of exemplary. While many organizations struggled to adapt to remote work and uncertain market conditions, her proactive measures ensured that CIGNEX not only survived but thrived. Her approach to crisis management combined clear communication, strategic foresight, and an unwavering focus on employee well-being.

By implementing robust remote working policies and digital transformation initiatives, she safeguarded productivity while prioritizing mental health. Her leadership during this turbulent period earned her accolades and cemented her reputation as a leader who can turn challenges into opportunities.

Championing Sustainability and Innovation

One of Dr. Ankita Singh's most remarkable contributions is her ability to align corporate objectives with broader societal goals. Her work in establishing the HR Association of India (HRAI) demonstrates her dedication to fostering collaboration and innovation within the HR community. By creating a platform for knowledge sharing and professional growth, she has elevated the industry's standards and inspired countless professionals to think beyond traditional boundaries.

In addition to her industry contributions, Dr. Singh is a staunch advocate for sustainable business practices. From promoting eco-friendly office initiatives to integrating sustainability into organizational strategies, she ensures that the organization stays ahead of the curve in addressing global challenges.

Her efforts reflect her belief that businesses can drive meaningful change without compromising profitability.

Shaping the Future of Leadership

Dr. Singh's impact extends far beyond her immediate role. As a mentor and thought leader, she is committed to grooming the next generation of leaders. Her emphasis on "building second lines of command" ensures that organizations are prepared for long-term success. By encouraging her mentees to lead with purpose and authenticity, she is shaping a new wave of leadership that values inclusivity and innovation.

Her achievements, including recognition as one of Asia's 100 Power Women Leaders and the recipient of the "Power Woman Leader of the Year 2023" award, are a testament to her influence. Yet, it is her passion for empowering others and creating lasting impact that truly defines her legacy.

Lessons from Her Journey

Dr. Ankita Singh's story offers invaluable lessons for today's business leaders:

- 1. Adaptability Is Key:** By embracing change and encouraging innovation, organizations can turn challenges into opportunities.
- 2. People-Centric Leadership:** Empowering individuals fosters loyalty, creativity, and resilience within teams.
- 3. Sustainability Matters:** Integrating sustainable practices into business strategies ensures long-term success and societal impact.
- 4. Mentorship Multiplies Impact:** Grooming future leaders creates a ripple effect that benefits organizations and industries alike.

As businesses navigate an increasingly complex and unpredictable landscape, leaders like Dr. Ankita Singh serve as examples of what is possible. Her journey is a powerful reminder that true leadership is not about authority or accolades but about building bridges, fostering resilience, and driving meaningful change.